

HTTP ARCHIVE TREND BRIEFING

State of the Web 2020–2025

Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

HTTP Archive crawl data • Jan 2020 – Mar 2026 • Desktop and mobile web



Coverage

Millions of URLs

Security

HTTPS at 99%+

Protocol shift

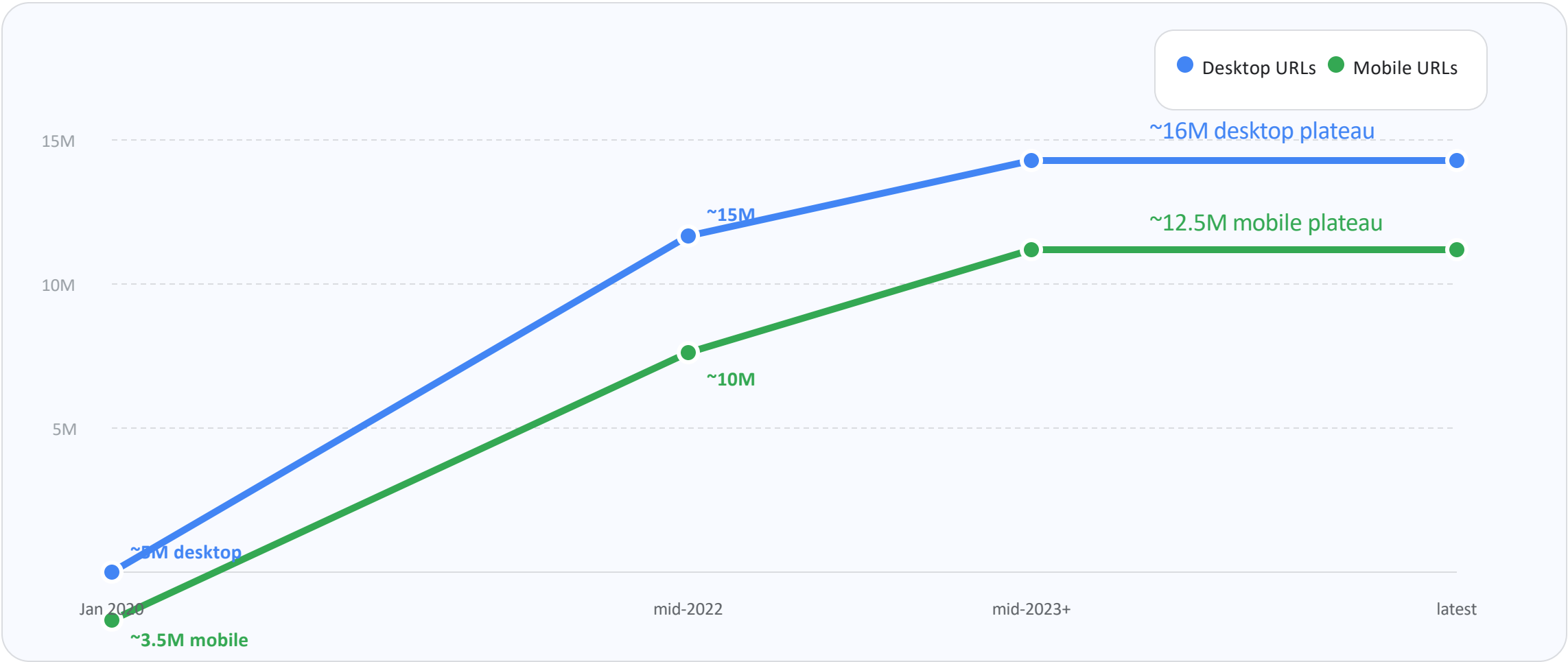
HTTP/3 near 40%

Audience: web performance engineers and front-end architects evaluating infrastructure trends



Crawl Sample Size Tripled

Desktop rose from ~5M URLs in Jan 2020 to a plateau near 16M; mobile stabilized near 12.5M.



Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Desktop median is ~25% heavier than early 2020; the 75th-percentile desktop page exceeds 4,000 KB.



Median transfer size

~2,000 KB

Long tail matters

75th-percentile desktop pages exceed 4,000 KB.

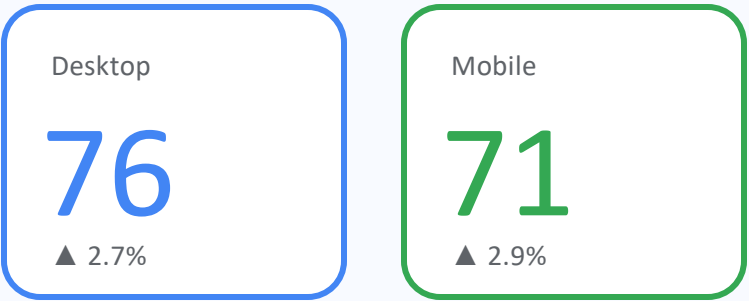
Trend signal

Desktop and mobile both up ~25%.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

More resources, fewer connections: multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 improves network efficiency.

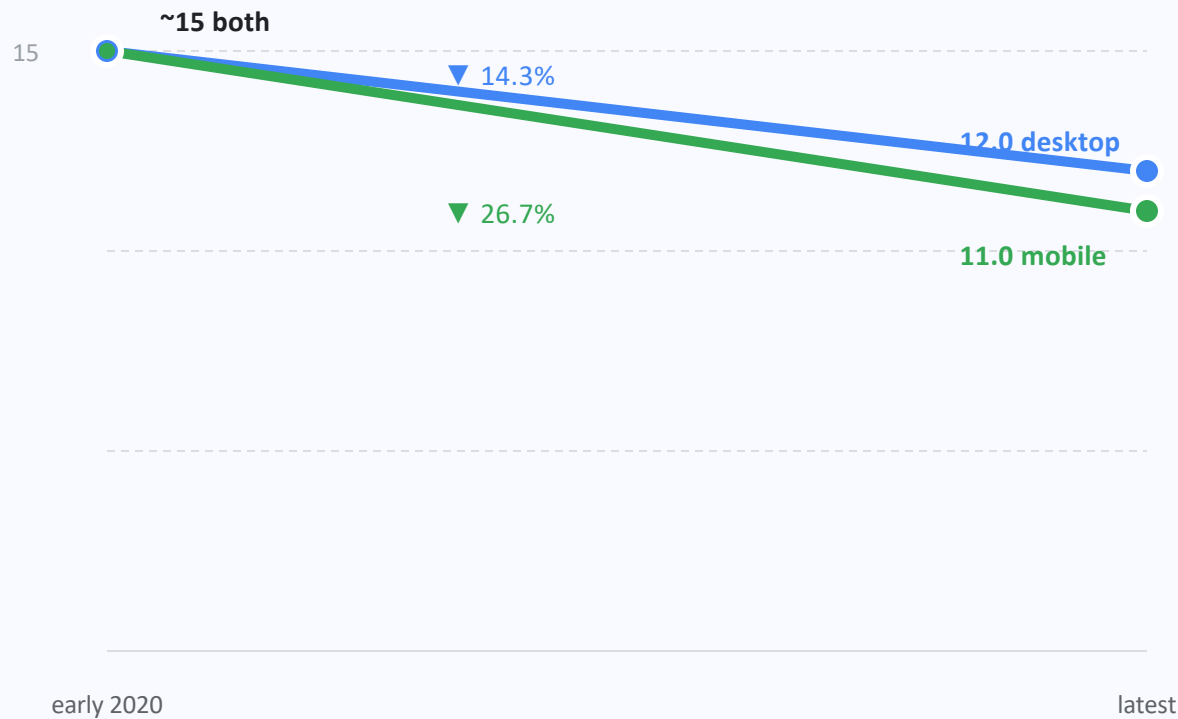
Median total requests



Interpretation

Request counts edged up, but connection pressure declined as modern protocols multiplex more work over fewer TCP connections.

TCP connections per page decline



HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

99.2% of desktop requests and 99.1% of mobile requests use HTTPS, up ~19–20 percentage points since early 2020.

Current HTTPS request share

99%+

Desktop

99.2%

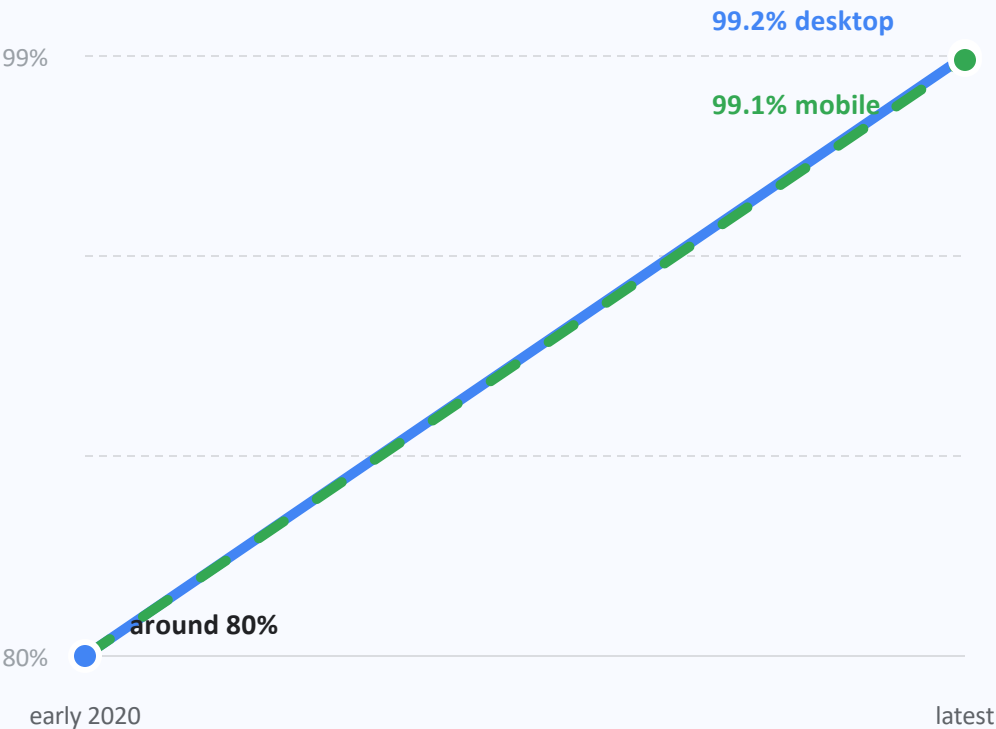
Mobile

99.1%

Plaintext HTTP is effectively gone

The modern web baseline is encrypted transport.

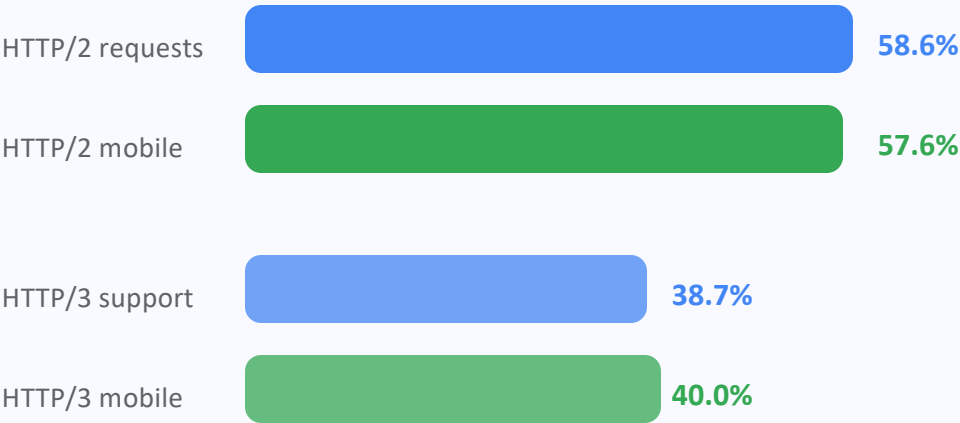
Climb from ~80% to 99%



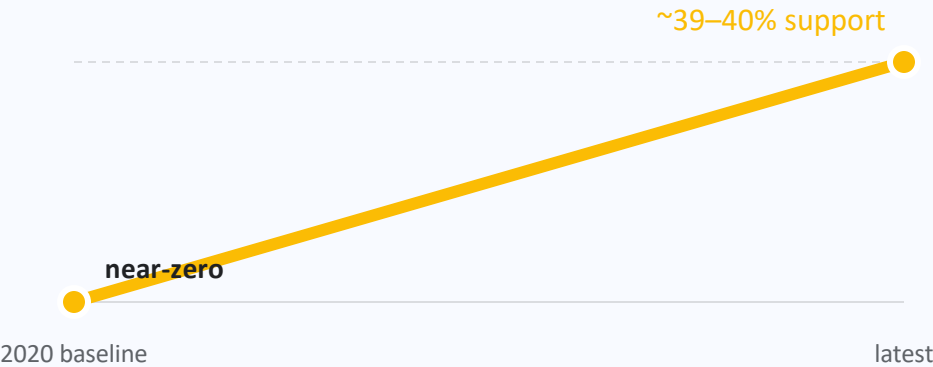
HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

HTTP/2 remains the largest request protocol share; HTTP/3 support is the fastest-growing protocol metric.

Latest protocol snapshot



HTTP/3 growth trajectory



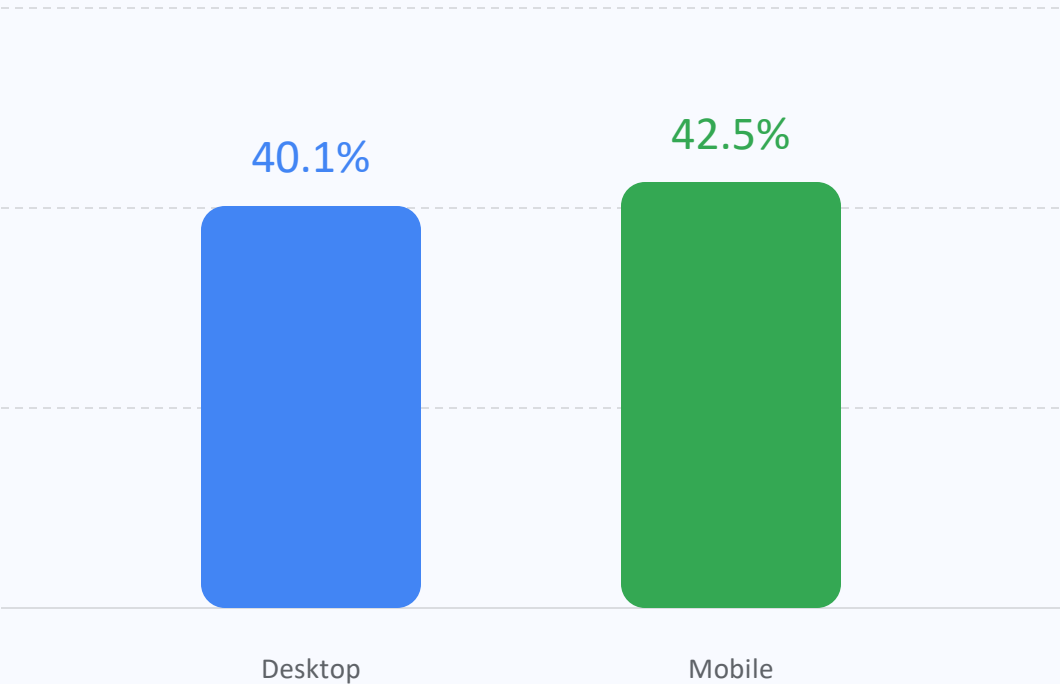
Measurement caveat

HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support, not actual usage, because fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 before discovering HTTP/3 capability via Alt-Svc headers.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

`font-display` helps avoid Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT), but more than half of pages still risk invisible text.

Current adoption by page type



Growth since 2020

+61.0% mobile

Desktop growth

+14.9%

Optimization gap

At ~40–42% adoption, more than half of pages still risk FOIT during web font loading.

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

Benchmark your own estate against the web-wide baselines before prioritizing 2026 optimization work.

01

Page weight keeps climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 2x more than in 2020.

02

HTTPS is the baseline

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web.

03

HTTP/3 is fastest-growing

From near-zero to ~40% support, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.

04

Fewer TCP connections

HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing has cut median connections per page by 15–27%.

05

Font-display still underused

At ~40–42% adoption, there is room to reduce FOIT risk.

Call to action

Compare your sites against these baselines: page KB, requests, TCP connections, HTTPS, HTTP/3, fonts.